AUGUSTA UNIVERSITY
DENTAL COLLEGE OF GEORGIA
SECTION OF DENTAL MATERIALS

Materials Evidence Review for Instruction and Treatment Subcommittee

MERIT charter, academic year 2026 to 2027

CHAIR
Section Director of Dental Materials; 2026 to 2027, Dr. Rafael Rocha Pacheco

REPORTS TO
Instrumentation Committee, Dental College of Georgia

SUBMIT PROPOSALS AT
pachecodcg.github.io/merit

VERSION
1.0, effective on approval

DATE
November 2026

FIRST REVIEW
MERIT-2026-01, resin composite warmers

In one paragraph. The Materials Evidence Review for Instruction and Treatment Subcommittee decides whether the evidence, safety and teaching value of a dental material justify its use at DCG, before anyone discusses price. Any faculty member can propose a material through one online form, with at least three peer-reviewed references. Within five business days the Chair confirms the proposal is complete and the review meeting is scheduled; the requestor presents, members weigh the evidence against what DCG uses now, and the voting members decide on merit alone; within 10 business days of the vote the requestor and the Instrumentation Committee receive the written recommendation. The Instrumentation Committee then decides on cost and purchase.

TIERS
2
Merit at MERIT, then cost and purchase at the Instrumentation Committee.

COMPLETENESS CHECK
5 business days
From submission to the Chair opening the review or returning it with guidance.

WRITTEN OUTCOME
10 business days
From the vote to the recommendation reaching the requestor and the Instrumentation Committee.

1 Purpose

1.1 **Merit before purchase.** MERIT is a standing subcommittee of the Instrumentation Committee of the Dental College of Georgia at Augusta University. It evaluates the scientific merit, clinical relevance, safety and educational value of dental materials and clinical instruments proposed for adoption, replacement or discontinuation at DCG.

1.2 **Two tiers, kept apart.** MERIT issues a written recommendation and makes no procurement or budget decision. Cost, purchase, storage and implementation stay with the Instrumentation Committee.

1.3 **One standard for the college.** A recommendation applies wherever the material is used: simulation lab, predoctoral clinics, residency programs, faculty practice and, as it opens, the Savannah campus.

2 Scope

CATEGORY	INCLUDES, NOT EXHAUSTIVE
Dental materials	Resin composites, adhesives, cements, glass ionomers and RMGIC, ceramics and zirconia, bioactive materials, bleaching agents, endodontic, impression and provisional materials, fluoride and preventive agents, primers and silanes, laboratory materials.
Instruments and devices	Burs, finishing and polishing systems, articulators, curing lights, shade systems, material warmers and delivery devices, other clinical armamentarium.
Capital equipment	Milling units, scanners and radiographic systems: advisory opinion at the request of the Instrumentation Committee, without a full review cycle.

3 Membership

ROLE	POSITION	VOTE	HOLDER, 2026 TO 2027
Chair	Section Director of Dental Materials	Yes; decides a tie	Dr. Rafael Rocha Pacheco
Core	Faculty of the Section of Dental Materials	Yes	Dr. Frederick A. Rueggeberg Dr. Gabriela Magalhães
Core	Chair, Department of Restorative Sciences	Yes	Dr. Hussein Assaf
Core	Chair, Department of General Dentistry	Yes	Dr. John Comisi
Ad hoc	Associate Dean for Patient Services	At the Chair’s discretion	Dr. Alan Furness
Ad hoc	Content experts appointed by the Chair for a review	At the Chair’s discretion	As needed
Liaisons	Clinic director and simulation lab director representatives	No	As designated

3.1 **Positions, not people.** Membership belongs to the position. When a position changes hands, the new holder joins MERIT without further action, and the Chair updates the holders at the annual charter review.

3.2 **Further experts.** The Chair may appoint ad hoc members for a material category under review, and may give an ad hoc member a vote for a specific review, including to restore a quorum after recusals.

4 Meetings and voting

4.1 **Quorum.** The Chair plus at least two voting members, core or ad hoc, who are not recused.

4.2 **Decision.** A simple majority of the voting members present. The Chair votes as a member; in a tie, the side of the Chair’s vote carries.

4.3 **Requestors at the meeting.** The requestor, or a designated co-requestor, presents the proposal and answers questions, then leaves before deliberation and the vote. A member who submits or supports a proposal does not vote on it.

4.4 **When we meet.** As needed once a complete proposal arrives, and at least once each academic year for the formulary review. In person or virtual; agendas five business days before, minutes within 10 business days after.

5 How a review unfolds

DAY 0

Submit

- Online form at pachecodcg.github.io/merit
- At least three peer-reviewed references
- Requestor receives a receipt and a MERIT ID

OWNER

Requestor

WITHIN 5 BUSINESS DAYS

Confirm

- Report and attachments reach the Chair by e-mail
- Completeness confirmed, or the requestor is contacted
- Reviewers assigned by category

OWNER

Chair

AFTER CONFIRMATION

Meet

- Meeting scheduled with voting members and the requestor
- Requestor presents, then leaves
- Evidence weighed against the current DCG standard

OWNER

Office of Digital Technologies, voting members

WITHIN 10 BUSINESS DAYS OF THE VOTE

Decide

- Vote on merit only; cost not discussed
- Written recommendation to the requestor and the Instrumentation Committee

OWNER

Voting members, Chair

5.1 **What a proposal includes.** The product and where it would be used, the problem it addresses and the proposed solution, at least three peer-reviewed references, and a conflict of interest statement. A comparison with the current DCG standard, the educational fit, safety notes and supporting files (up to 15 MB) are encouraged. Requestors may answer “not sure” where they do not know, and do not recommend an outcome; that is the subcommittee’s role.

5.2 **Administrative support.** The Office of Digital Technologies supports MERIT. Each submission places a completeness reminder on the Chair’s calendar 5 business days later, shared with Mary Hood, who schedules the review meeting once the Chair confirms the proposal.

6 Recommendations

OUTCOME	MEANING AND NEXT STEP
Approved	Evidence supports adoption. Referred to the Instrumentation Committee for procurement and implementation.
Approved for pilot	Evidence is promising. A pilot of two to three months, with selected clinicians, supervised students and a defined rubric, comes before a final recommendation.
Deferred	Gaps in the proposal or the evidence prevented a full evaluation. Resubmission is welcome once they are addressed.
Not recommended	Evidence does not support adoption or replacement of the current standard. Resubmission is possible if substantial new evidence emerges.

7 Policies

7.1 **Conflict of interest.** Every member completes the annual conflict of interest disclosure. A member with a conflict on a specific material recuses from that vote and may take part in discussion. No manufacturer or distributor representative is present during deliberation or voting.

7.2 **Formulary.** MERIT keeps the DCG Materials Formulary, reviews it each year for outdated or superseded products and reports its findings to the Instrumentation Committee.

7.3 **Records.** Every submission carries a MERIT ID and reaches the Chair as a report with its attachments. Submissions, minutes and recommendations are kept for at least five years and are available to DCG faculty on request through the Chair.

7.4 **Charter review.** The Chair reviews this charter each year. Amendments need a majority of core voting members and the endorsement of the Instrumentation Committee.

8 Approvals

CHAIR, MERIT

Rafael Rocha Pacheco, DDS, MSc, PhD
Associate Dean for Digital Technologies
Section Director of Dental Materials
Date

CHAIR, INSTRUMENTATION COMMITTEE

Date

ASSOCIATE DEAN FOR PATIENT SERVICES

Dr. Alan Furness
Associate Dean for Patient Services
Date

DEAN

Dr. Theresa Gonzales
Interim Dean, Dental College of Georgia
Date

DENTAL COLLEGE OF GEORGIA
Section of Dental Materials

Mailing Address:
1120 15th Street, GC 5124
Augusta, Georgia 30912

Office Address:
1430 John Wesley Gilbert Drive, GC 5124
Augusta, Georgia 30912

T (706) 721-8315
E rapacheco@augusta.edu

augusta.edu